CHAPTER 17

The research report

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

After completing Chapter 17 you should be able to:

1. Describe the characteristics of a well-written research report that is tailored to the needs of a specific audience.
2. Write a thorough and complete research report.
3. Describe the characteristics of a good oral presentation and deliver a good oral presentation.

INTRODUCTION

The key purpose of any research report is to offer a clear description of what has been done in the various stages of the research process. Hence, a research report may possibly include information on the formulation of the problem statement, a critical review of the literature, the development of a theoretical framework, the collection of data, the analysis of the data, and the interpretation of the results.

When researchers describe what has been done in the research, they should keep the hallmarks of scientific research in mind. For instance, the researcher started the research with a definite aim or purpose. It is imperative to inform the reader about the specific aim or purpose of the research project as soon as possible; that is, in the introductory section of the research report. The researcher should also keep the criterion of replicability in mind; a research report is well written when a colleague researcher is able to replicate the research after reading the report. It is also important that the results of the study and the recommendations for solving the problem are objectively and effectively communicated to the sponsor, so that